



Grant's zebra

Equus quagga boehmi

Grant's zebras migrate to find food, traveling up to 1,800 miles (3,000km) in search of the coarse long grass that they are best-adapted to eat. The smallest of the plains zebras, they are highly adaptable, and are able to survive in harsh conditions on the plains and in woodland at sea-level and on the slopes of Mount Kenya at heights of up to 13,000 ft (4,000m).

Easily recognized by their black-and-white striped bodies (the function of which is not known for certain), zebras are social animals. They form close-knit family units that graze in large herds across East and Southern

Africa. They are often joined by wildebeest, giraffes, and Thomson's gazelles, which benefit from the zebras' warning "bray-bark" when a predator is spotted. Zebras can also maintain a top speed of 35–40mph (55–65km/h), outlasting short-burst predators such as lions.

A family unit consists of a dominant stallion and several mares—the harem—and their foals. Males leave to join bachelor herds at between one and three years of age. Adult males try to lure females away, or take over a harem, resulting in violent fights. Most foals are born during the rainy season, after a year-long gestation.



△ CHAPMAN'S ZEBRA
A less-common subspecies of the plains zebra, *E. q. chapmani* has dark stripes alternating with fainter shadow stripes.

↔ 7–8 ft (2.2–2.5 m)

🏠 385–850 lb (175–385 kg)

⊗ Common

🌾 Grass

🏠

E. Africa



◁ DEADLY DUEL
Fighting between stallions over mating rights is fierce, involving bites, powerful kicks, and strikes that frequently cause damage—and sometimes kill.



◁ SAFETY IN NUMBERS
Zebras have superb eyesight, hearing, and a sharp sense of smell, which help detect predators. Living in a herd means more senses at work, making it safer for members.